

Topic Listening: Demographics



THE LONDON SCHOOL
OF ECONOMICS AND
POLITICAL SCIENCE ■

You are going to watch a video which asks how some of the world's biggest economies will cope with rapidly aging populations?

- The first part features Bloomberg experts Jamie Murray, Chief Economist EMEA of Bloomberg Intelligence and BI Chief global economist Mike McDonough.
- The second part features author, diplomat and academic Professor Stephen Chan.
- And the third part looks at how the German car industry is adapting to cater for elderly workers and travels to Southern Italy to examine big demographic movements there.

Before watching



- a) What are demographics?
- b) What do you think the 'demographic timebomb' is?
- c) Read the questions below on the next slide and predict the answers.

Questions



1. Why are demographics important?
2. How are demographics changing?
3. What are the economic consequences of an aging population?
4. Which countries are approaching a 'demographic sweet spot'?
5. Which countries have 'worrying' demographics?
6. What kind of decisions do governments with aging demographics need to make?
7. What are some of the demographic challenges in China, Japan and Germany and how have their governments responded?
8. How have the following responded to demographic change: a) Daimler, Germany; b) Satriano, Italy?
9. How does the documentary conclude?

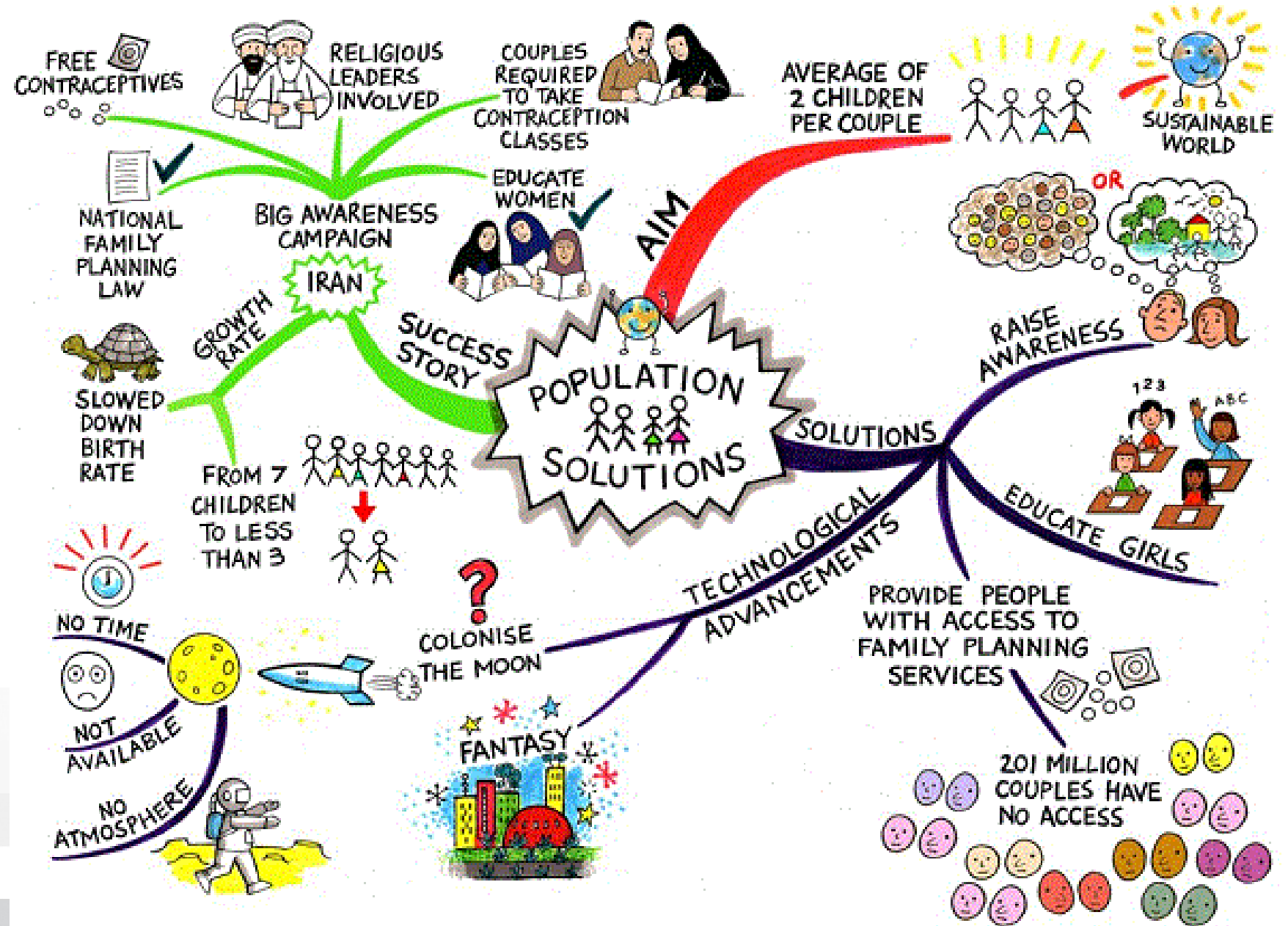
Listening



[Watch Forward Thinking: The Demographic Timebomb - Bloomberg](#)

After Listening

Use your notes to create a mind map like the one below (Note: this mind map is about population but is not based on the documentary)



What are the main demographic challenges in your country? How is your government responding?

